Ireland to invite Trump's trade chief to Brussels for November talks

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Ireland to invite Trump's trade chief to Brussels for November talks
By Camille Gijs · Oct 23, 2026, 7:10 PM · View in your browser

DUBLIN — U.S. Trade Representative Jamieson Greer will be invited to Brussels at the end of November for a meeting of EU trade ministers to discuss Washington's steel tariffs, Ireland's trade minister told POLITICO on Friday.

"That's the intention," said Helen McEntee, whose country is helming the presidency of the Council of the EU and sets the agenda for its meetings.

Greer had been due to attend an informal meeting of EU trade ministers in Dublin on Thursday and Friday this week, but declined citing scheduling conflicts. McEntee said Ireland and EU countries still hoped to meet with him.

"We would be keen to have that engagement and I think member states would like that as well," McEntee said in an interview with POLITICO on the sidelines of a meeting of trade ministers in Dublin.

The next gathering of trade ministers takes place Nov. 30 in Brussels, with the European Commission under pressure to secure a tariff reduction on steel products from the Trump administration. In line with the EU regulations implementing the transatlantic Turnberry trade deal agreed last year, the Commission must report to the European Parliament and member governments by Dec. 1 on whether Washington is keeping its side of the bargain on steel tariffs.

The U.S. still applies tariffs on steel and aluminum of up to 50% — above the general ceiling of 15% for tariffs on EU goods that was agreed at Turnberry. The minister added that while some 75% of metal derivatives fall below the 15% threshold, "for the 25% that do not, it's a big deal."

"So we have between now and then to intensify our efforts and … really hone in and focus in on that … For the businesses impacted, it obviously has a huge impact."

The invitation comes after Washington repeated a warning that it won't lower steel tariffs on EU steel products unless Brussels softens its enforcement of tech rules.

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